

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Websites, Funnels and Local SEO

Building and shipping a client site that converts and gets found

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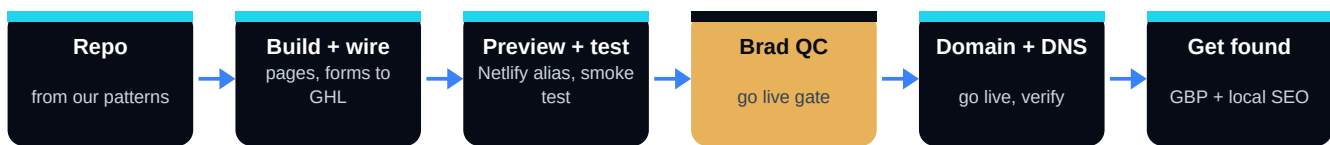
WHAT THIS IS

This is how we build, wire, test and ship a client website or funnel, and how we set up the Google presence that makes it get found. You use it on every site build, every landing page, every form change and every Google Business Profile task. It produces a live site on the client's domain whose forms land in GHL, with proof that a real visitor can book without calling.

DONE MEANS

The site is live on the client's domain with SSL, loads in under three seconds on a phone, every form creates a contact in the client's GHL sub account with the right tag, the Google Business Profile is claimed and complete, and Brad has passed the go live gate.

01 The whole flow



Every site follows this path. The gold box is the go live gate. Only Brad or Cash pass it.

Brad	Web Developer	Technical Builder	Client
Approves scope. Passes go live QC. Owns easyworks.ai production and every domain change. Holds the secrets.	Builds the site from our patterns, wires forms, deploys to preview, runs the smoke test, attaches proof.	Supplies the GHL side: fields, tags, calendar, the chat widget. See EW-TECH-04.	Supplies brand assets, copy facts, domain access, and adds us to their Google Business Profile.

A client site has one job: turn a visitor into a booked appointment or a captured lead without a phone call. Design is in service of that. Speed is in service of that. If a page is beautiful and the form goes nowhere, the build failed.

Stack facts

Hosting	Netlify, static site plus Netlify Functions v2 (.mjs files in netlify/functions/).
Repos	One repository per client site under the easyworksai GitHub organisation. Never mix two clients in one repo.
Deploys	Manual, with the Netlify CLI. Nothing auto deploys from GitHub. Preview alias first, production second, never the other way round.
Your access	Per repo and per site deploy rights for the client you are assigned to. Nothing else.
easyworks.ai	The Easyworks production site is Brad only. You will never have deploy rights to it and should never need them.
Forms	Every form posts to GHL by webhook or API. A Netlify Forms inbox on its own is not a lead system.
Serverless rule	Await every CRM write before you return a response. Fire and forget never runs on serverless.

02 Brand rules

There are two brands in play on every job and they never mix.

Surface	Whose brand	What that means
The client's site, funnel, forms, chat widget, emails	The client's	Their logo, colours, fonts, photos, voice. Real photos of their team and premises are good here. We do not put Easyworks colours or the Easyworks mascot on a client site.
Anything with the Easyworks name on it: our site, our decks, our reports, our portal, our own landing pages	Easyworks brand v3	Navy #070b16 base, electric blue #3b82f6, cyan #22d3ee. Gold #e8b25a only for money. No purple, no rainbow. No real human faces, only the faceless mascot or vector glyphs.

RULE

If the client has no brand, build them a simple one in the task (one logo lockup, two colours, one font pair) and get it approved before you touch the pages. Do not default to Easyworks colours because they are handy.

NOTE

The client's photos go on the client's site. Real faces never go on an Easyworks surface. If you are not sure which surface you are on, ask in the task.

03 Page standards

These apply to every page we ship, home page or single landing page. Check them before you ask for review, because Brad checks them at the gate.

Every page, before review

- ☐ Mobile first. Design and test at 375px and 768px before desktop. Most of the client's customers are on a phone.
- ☐ Loads in under three seconds on a phone connection. Images sized for the slot they sit in, lazy loaded below the fold, no 4000px originals.
- ☐ One clear call to action above the fold. Book, call, or get a quote. Not three competing buttons.
- ☐ A visitor can book without calling. Booking widget or form on the page, not just a phone number.
- ☐ Phone number is clickable on mobile (a tel link) and matches the number on Google Business Profile exactly.
- ☐ SSL on the final domain and on the preview. No mixed content warnings.
- ☐ No broken links, no placeholder text, no lorem ipsum, no stock claims the client did not make.
- ☐ Title tag, meta description and one H1 per page. Title pattern: Service in City, then the brand name.
- ☐ Business name, address and phone on every page footer, matching Google word for word.
- ☐ LocalBusiness schema on the home page, Service schema on service pages, FAQ schema where there is an FAQ.
- ☐ Works with JavaScript slow or blocked: the form still submits and the phone number still shows.

SPEED IS A GATE

Under three seconds is a hard number. Run Lighthouse on mobile. Below 80 on performance means fix images and scripts before review, not after.

04 Forms into GHL

A form that lands in an inbox nobody reads is a lost lead. Every form we ship creates or updates a contact in the client's GHL sub account, tags it by source, and triggers the follow up the client asked for. Two ways to do it, pick the simplest that works.

Method	Use it when	How
GHL form or inbound webhook	A plain contact form with standard fields and no logic.	Embed the GHL form, or post the site form to a GHL inbound webhook trigger in a workflow. The workflow creates the contact and tags it.
Netlify Function calling the GHL API	You need validation, reshaping, a second system, or anything with logic.	A <code>.mjs</code> function receives the POST, validates, then calls the contacts upsert endpoint. Pattern in EW-TECH-08 Integrations.

The function pattern, in short

1

Receive and validate

Parse the body. Require a phone or an email. Reject junk with a 400 and a plain message. Never crash on a bad payload.

End state: an empty POST returns 400, not a 500.

2

Upsert by phone

Call the GHL contacts upsert endpoint with `locationId`, name, phone, email, tags and source. Upsert means the same person submitting twice does not become two contacts.

End state: a second submit with the same phone updates the existing contact.

3

Tag by source

Add a tag that names where the lead came from: the site, the page, the campaign. The client's workflows key off these tags.

End state: the contact shows the tag in GHL.

4

Await every write

Serverless tears the function down after the response. A write you did not await may never run. Await the upsert, await the tag, then respond.

End state: the contact exists before the thank you page shows.

5

Confirm the contact appears

Open the sub account, find the contact, check fields and tags. Screenshot it for the task.

End state: a screenshot of the contact in GHL is on the task.

SECRETS

The sub account token lives in the Netlify site's environment variables, set by Brad. It never goes in the repo, in a task, in a Loom, or in an AI tool. If you need a token you do not have, hit Blocked and say which site.

TIP

Test with a phone number that is not already a contact. Then test again with the same number. One contact, two submissions. If you see two contacts, the upsert is wrong.

05 Deploy and the smoke test loop

1

Go into the project folder first

`cd ~/Projects/<client>` before any Netlify command. The CLI walks up the folder tree looking for a link file, and a parent folder link can point your deploy at the wrong site.

End state: `netlify status` shows the client's site name, not easyworks.

2

Deploy to a preview alias

`netlify deploy --dir=. --alias=<alias> --site <siteId> --message "what changed".`

Always pass the site explicitly.

End state: the CLI prints a preview URL on the client's Netlify site.

3

Run the smoke test

Loop over every page path with curl and confirm a 200. Then open the preview on a real phone and click through every link and every form.

End state: every path returns 200 and every form creates a GHL contact.

4

Fix, redeploy, repeat

Small changes, small deploys. Do not stack ten fixes into one deploy and hope.

5

Attach proof and move to review

Preview URL, the smoke test output, mobile screenshots at 375px, the GHL contact screenshot, Lighthouse mobile score.

End state: task in review with all five attached.

6

Production deploy

Only after Brad passes QC. `netlify deploy --prod --dir=. --site <siteId>` from inside the project folder. If functions changed and the deploy looks stale, add `--skip-functions-cache`.

End state: the production URL shows the new build. Verify with a cache busted request, not the CLI message.

THE PARENT LINK TRAP

Never run a bare `netlify deploy` from a folder under `~/Projects/`. A parent link file there points at the live Easyworks site. Always `cd` into the client project and pass `--site`.

TIP

The smoke test is a loop, not a step. Every deploy gets the same test. When it is boring, you are doing it right.

A minimal smoke test looks like this. Keep the list of paths in the repo README so the next person runs the same one.

- `for p in / /services/ /book/ /contact/ /thanks/ /404.html; do curl -s -o /dev/null -w "%{http_code} $p\n" "https://<previewUrl>$p"; done`
- Then on a phone: tap every nav item, submit every form, tap the phone number, load the booking widget.

06 Domain, DNS and go live verification

Domain changes are the one place where a small mistake takes a business off the internet. Brad does the DNS change or is on the call while it happens. Your job is to prepare everything so the switch takes minutes.

1

Find out who controls the domain

Registrar name, who has the login, whether email runs on the same domain. Never ask for the registrar password. Ask the client to add a record or to join a screen share.

End state: the task names the registrar and the person.

2

Add the domain in Netlify

Domain settings on the client's site. Netlify shows the exact records needed.

End state: the domain shows as pending in Netlify with the records listed.

3

Prepare the DNS records

Write the exact records in the task: the apex record, the www CNAME, and leave every mail record untouched. If email runs on this domain, list the MX records you are not touching.

End state: Brad can read the task and make the change without asking a question.

4

Make the change (Brad, or client with Brad on the call)

Change only the listed records. Lower the TTL first if you can.

5

Verify like a visitor

Open the domain on a phone on mobile data, not on your own wifi. Check the padlock. Check www and the apex both land. Submit a form. Check the contact in GHL.

End state: screenshots of the live domain, the padlock, and the GHL contact on the task.

6

Set up Search Console and Analytics

Add the domain property in Google Search Console and, if the client wants analytics, a GA4 property. See section 07 for access.

VERIFY BEFORE CLAIMING LIVE

Published is not visible. The CLI saying deployed, the registrar saying saved, Netlify saying verified: none of that is proof. Proof is the site loading on a phone that is not yours and a form landing in GHL.

WATCH OUT

Touching MX records or the root record without a written plan can kill the client's email for a day. If email is on the domain and you are not certain, hit Blocked and wait for Brad.

07 Google Business Profile and local SEO basics

For a local business the phone rings because of Google, not because of the website alone. The Google Business Profile is the single highest value SEO move and it comes first. The site supports it.

Access, the right way

1

Audit the listings first

Search the business on Google Maps. List every listing you find and its status: verified, duplicate, suspended, permanently closed. Note which one has the reviews.

End state: the task lists every listing and which one is the keeper.

2

Ask for a manager invite on the verified listing

The client adds the Easyworks team mailbox as a Manager from their Business Profile settings, people and access. Never ask for their Google password.

End state: you can open the listing from the team account.

3

Ask for Search Console access

The client adds the Easyworks team mailbox as a user with Full permission on their domain property.

Restricted blocks some data we pull. If they have no property, we create a domain property and verify with a DNS TXT record.

End state: the property shows in our Search Console list.

DUPLICATES AND MOVES

If a client moved and made a new listing, the reviews on the old one do not transfer and cannot be pulled out of a closed or suspended listing. Never promise to get them back. Edit the existing listing when a client moves, never create a new one.

GBP setup checklist

- ☐ Claimed and verified. One listing, duplicates reported and merged.
- ☐ Primary category matches the main service. Up to ten secondary categories that match real services.
- ☐ Every service listed with a one paragraph description in the client's words.
- ☐ Service areas set to every city they actually serve.
- ☐ Name, address, phone and hours match the website and every directory exactly.
- ☐ At least twenty photos: logo, storefront, team, work samples, interior.
- ☐ Description written for a person, under the character limit, mentions the main services and city.
- ☐ Booking link points at the client's GHL booking page.
- ☐ Messaging on, with the reply handled through GHL.
- ☐ Five to ten questions seeded and answered in the Q and A section.

Local SEO basics on the site and beyond

Area	The standard	Proof for the task
On page	Title, meta, one H1, schema, internal links between service pages, descriptive alt text.	Screenshot of the page source or a crawler report.
NAP consistency	Same name, address, phone everywhere: site, GBP, directories, social.	A short table of where you checked.
Citations	Listed on the main directories for the region and the industry, all matching NAP.	List of submitted directories with dates.
Reviews	A GHL workflow asks for a review the day after the job, one tap to the review link. Every review answered within a day. See EW-TECH-05.	Workflow screenshot and the first review request sent.
Posts	A GBP post at least weekly, queued four weeks ahead where the client supplies content.	The queue in the task.
Tracking	Search Console connected with Full permission, GA4 if in scope.	Screenshot of the property with our access.

CONFIRM WITH BRAD

Brad's SEO ops system pulls Search Console data weekly for every connected client and builds the monthly rank report. Your job is to get the access and log what you did in the task. How the work log is fed is confirmed per client.

08 Handoff evidence and definition of done

Handoff evidence

The client never sees our internal framing. They see a short walkthrough of their site, where their leads land, and how to check them. Attach to the task:

- A two minute Loom on a phone: the live site, a form submit, the contact appearing in GHL.
- The list of pages and forms, and which tag each form applies.
- Where the repo is, where the site is in Netlify, and the smoke test paths (in the README).
- The GBP status and what access we hold.

Definition of done

- ☐ Site live on the client's domain with SSL, www and apex both resolving.
- ☐ Page standards checklist in section 03 passed on every page, Lighthouse mobile 80 or above.
- ☐ Every form creates a tagged contact in the client's GHL sub account, verified with a screenshot.
- ☐ Smoke test paths in the README and passing on production.
- ☐ Booking works from the site without a phone call.
- ☐ GBP claimed, checklist above complete or the gaps named in the task with who owns them.
- ☐ Search Console access confirmed from the team account.
- ☐ Handoff evidence attached. Client state file facts supplied in the task.
- ☐ Task moved to review. Brad or Cash marked it done. The client heard the word live only after that.

When it goes wrong

Symptom	First three checks	Who to tell
Deploy went to the wrong site	1. Which folder were you in? 2. Did you pass --site? 3. Is there a .netlify folder in a parent directory?	Brad now. If easyworks.ai changed, that is an incident.
Form submits but no contact in GHL	1. Function logs in Netlify for the error. 2. Is the token set on this site and for this sub account? 3. Did you await the write before responding?	Task notes. If the client is live, Blocked and Brad.
Two contacts for one person	1. Are you calling upsert, not create? 2. Is the phone formatted the same both times? 3. Is a GHL workflow also creating contacts from the same form?	Task notes.
Site is slow on mobile	1. Image sizes and formats. 2. Third party scripts loading above the fold. 3. Fonts and unused CSS.	Task notes with the Lighthouse report.
Domain shows not secure or does not load	1. DNS records match what Netlify asked for? 2. Propagation time passed? 3. Certificate issued in Netlify domain settings?	Brad, same hour. Domains are his.
Client email stopped after the DNS change	1. Were MX records touched? 2. Compare current records to the plan in the task. 3. Restore the mail records immediately.	Brad now. This is urgent.
GBP suspended or duplicate appeared	1. What changed in the listing recently? 2. Any category or address edits? 3. Is there a second listing under another account?	Brad. Do not appeal or delete anything on your own.